

NEURO-LOGICAL FLEXIBILITY & RIGIDITY

Neuro-logical flexibility is a person's willingness to adapt their behaviour and thoughts to new, changing, or unexpected information and events. In other words, it's the willingness to see when you're doing something that is not working, and then make the necessary changes to adapt to new situations.

Neuro-logical flexibility plays an essential role in problem-solving. It allows you to respond to situations flexibly and efficiently, adjusting your behaviour as the situation demands.

In learning, someone who is flexible in their thinking will be open to new ideas and perspectives and will take time to reflect upon concepts that they don't immediately understand, rather than dismissing them.

In relationships, neurologically flexibility means taking time to listen and understand others and appreciating that our own perspective will always be limited. It also means allowing others the opportunity to finish speaking before reaching a conclusion or judgement. A person of mental flexibility can better tolerate changes and mistakes; they will consider a situation from someone else's perspective and will work to find a compromise with others.

Contrastingly, mental rigidity is an unwillingness to change behaviour or beliefs when they are no longer working.

In learning, a person who is inflexibly minded will often be disinterested in hearing anything that contradicts their own perspective, beliefs or worldviews. Their goal in learning is usually to listen to information for the purpose of having their own beliefs validated. An individual who is rigid in their thinking will reject ideas that they disagree with and would often prefer to prove other people wrong than have their own worldview expanded.

Someone inflexible in their thinking will hold firmly to the belief that they must be 'right' all of the time and will at times take offence when someone or something does not meet their expectations.

Take a few moments to reflect on the following questions and consider how neuro-logically flexible you are:

1. When something is not working, do you change your approach to adapt where necessary until you've found a viable solution or would you be more likely to give up?



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2. When you're studying or presented with new information, would you reflectively consider new ideas and perspectives that you don't immediately understand or would you be more likely to dismiss them?

3. When you're studying, is your goal to have your own beliefs validated or do you purposefully set out to expand your existing worldview?

4. In your relationships, do you take time to listen and understand other people's perspectives, or would you be likely to spend more time talking to others about your own perspective?

5. In your interactions with others, do you allow them the opportunity to finish speaking before reaching a conclusion or judgement, or would you be more likely to make quick judgements based on something they've said?



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6. When someone or something does not meet your expectations, would you be willing to adapt and look for the value in what's being delivered, or would you be more likely to take offence?

7. In what ways could you adapt to become more neuro-logically flexible in your thinking, in your approach to learning and your interactions with others?

